

binaries,” says Lakshmi. Its life insurance nomination now includes partners of people who identify as LGBT+.

“We have enabled our people with disabilities to work effectively from home with the help of the right technology and tools including assistive technologies and ergonomic adjustments,” says Lakshmi. It also understands the importance of flexi working. “No one size fits all and therefore our approach to how, when and where our people work will vary by business, team, and the type of work our people do. Accordingly, we are not setting one date for all our people to return to office, because it will vary,” says Lakshmi. Accenture has had flexible working policies for certain roles even before the pandemic, which changed to nearly 100 per cent. To enable work from home, it extended a \$250 allowance to purchase furniture, etc. “When we think about the future of work, we look beyond spaces and places and focus on creating omni-connected experiences for our people to form connections with each other and with our clients so that regardless of where one works, everyone can contribute equally,” says Lakshmi.

Accenture is setting up a presence in cities such as Jaipur, Indore and Coimbatore. “We are ensuring that our people have a healthy balance between the flexibility they need and the in-person connection time which is vital, both to their professional development and growth, and to the success of our client relationships. Our presence in these select cities will provide our people with work options that fulfil both these needs,” says Lakshmi.

Accenture provides its employees the options to move across teams enabling boundary-less career opportunities. Says Mohona Dey, Senior Manager-Functional Strategy, Accenture in India, who made a shift from sales to consulting when she joined Accenture, “The transition was made easy thanks to the accelerated learning path that Accenture offered to me and the hands-on exposure of working across industry sectors.” Last year, Accenture extended a one-time thank you bonus to all employees up to associate director level and promoted a record 120,000 people globally. “Besides our annual December cycle, we added multiple rounds of promotions through the year so as to be more agile as we made investments in our people’s growth and accelerated career progression for our high performers,” says Lakshmi. Accenture is also focussed on building a pipeline of future leaders. “For all critical leadership roles, we periodically look at matching aspirations, skills and opportunities so as to create business resilience. Our ongoing performance achievement process helps us capture aspirations, which then helps us keep our succession plans refreshed,” says Lakshmi. It runs leadership development programmes for existing leaders as well as future leaders. There is a special one for women. “For high-potential women, we adopt a 4R approach—Right



FLEXI WORKING Lakshmi C., MD and Lead-Human Resources, Accenture in India

| 55

4	ACCENTURE IN INDIA
	Top attributes
● Clarity of company goals ● Growth and learning opportunities ● Flexibility at work	

Skill, Right Role, Right Client and Right Sponsor and have 6-9-month-long on-the-job learning programmes to accelerate their advancement to leadership roles,” she says.

While Accenture does not share country-wise attrition rates, it was 14 per cent for the company as a whole last year. Accenture globally has a strength of 674,000 people. Millennial and GenZ employees make up nearly 90 per cent of the workforce of Accenture in India.

The company encourages employees to set personalised priorities; the performance management process helps managers to focus on these priorities and share continuous feedback. “Our purpose, which is to deliver on the promise of technology and human ingenuity, shapes our overall growth strategy and priorities,” says Lakshmi. **BT**

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